

**CSCI 32032 –
Research Methodology and Scientific Communication
(A/Y 2023/2024)
Assignment 1**

Blueprint for Discovery

Objective: To help students draft a compliant research proposal outline based on the FYP guidelines.

Phase 1: Problem Crystallization

In your lectures, we discussed the **Technique Involved in Defining a Problem**. Now, apply that to your FYP.

- **Task:** Define your research problem in a single paragraph. Identify the "knowledge gap" discussed in the Introduction section of the guidelines.
- **Constraint Check:** Ensure your project title does not exceed **10 words**.
- **Pathway Alignment:** Verify that your chosen topic fits within your specific degree pathway.

Phase 2: Choosing Your Template

The guidelines provide two distinct structures. Students must decide which applies to their intent.

- **Template 1 (Research):** Focused on Aims, Methodology, and Data Analysis.
- **Template 2 (Development):** Requires a **Project Charter** (stakeholders, business needs) and a **Feasibility Analysis**.
- **Requirement:** If you choose Template 2, remember that a demonstration of hardware or software is **mandatory** for evaluation.

Phase 3: Methodology & Ethics Mapping

Building on our lectures on **Experimental Design** and **Data Collection**, outline your "Project Protocol".

- **Sampling & Data:** Specify your sampling frame and data collection instruments (e.g., questionnaires or observation methods).
- **Ethical Concerns:** Reflect on our lecture on measurement errors. Identify any ethical issues raised by your study and how you will address them.
- **Timeline Logic:** Create a rough "Time Frame" using the guidelines' 34-week schedule. Remember, students are expected to engage in at least **400 hours** of project work.

Phase 4: "Supervisor" Pitch and Proposal

- Prepare a 3-minute elevator pitch for a potential supervisor. Your supervisor will eventually be responsible for reviewing your draft proposal.
- Prepare a draft proposal document.

Submit the draft proposal and elevator pitch.

Submission Deadline: **20th June 2026, 11.59 PM**